

Japan Industrial Electronics: June MOF data (optical fiber/cable): Sharp growth in optical fiber/cable export value; fundamentals favorable

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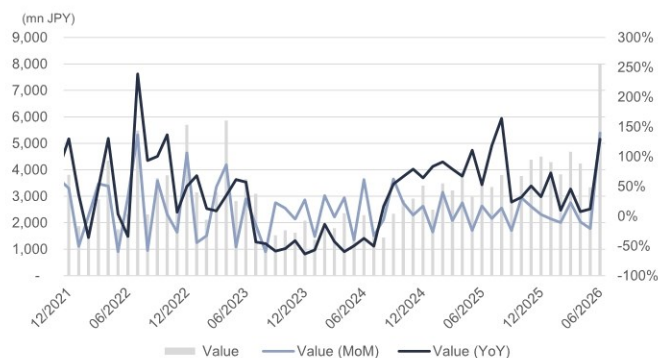
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According to Ministry of Finance (MOF) trade statistics for June (released on July 30), export value was +129% yoy for optical fiber cable and +56% yoy for optical fiber (including some other optical fiber cables). The ASP for optical fiber grew +55% yoy. As seen in [Corning's results](#) on July 28, fundamentals for the optical industry appear favorable. Against this backdrop, a valuation gap continues to exist for Japanese optical-related companies on a forward P/E (LSEG) basis, with Fujikura at 24X, Sumitomo Electric Industries at 18X, and Furukawa Electric at 20X, versus Corning at 32X, and we look for this gap to narrow.

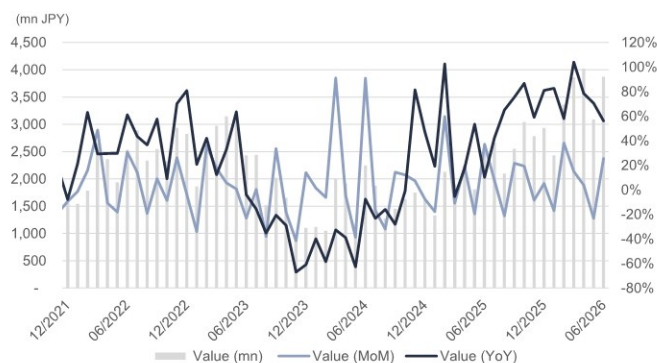
Heading into 1Q results, we focus in particular on Sumitomo Electric, which we think has significant room for an upward revision to guidance for its infocommunications business. For Fujikura, which [announced](#) an upward revision on June 19, we see limited room for further revisions, but there is potential for a positive forex impact given the recent yen weakness. Its 2H guidance also still looks conservative. For Furukawa Electric, we think 2H earnings are more likely to be a catalyst, as water-cooled cold plates, the biggest driver, will contribute from 2H. In the near term, some investors are citing the possibility of some form of equity financing for large-scale investments as a concern ([link](#)). For Anritsu, a manufacturer of optical transceiver test equipment, we expect strong earnings as demand related to 800 G/1.6 T is also strong.

By destination ([Exhibit 7](#)), ASPs for exports of both optical fiber and optical fiber cable to the US increased yoy and qoq. By customs jurisdiction ([Exhibit 9](#)), the value of optical fiber cable was up yoy at Tokyo, Yokohama, and Nagoya, suggesting the possibility that exports from the three major cable manufacturers are increasing. The main manufacturing bases of the three major cable companies in our coverage are Fujikura: Chiba (Tokyo customs jurisdiction), Sumitomo Electric: Yokohama (Yokohama customs jurisdiction), and Furukawa Electric: Mie (Nagoya customs jurisdiction).

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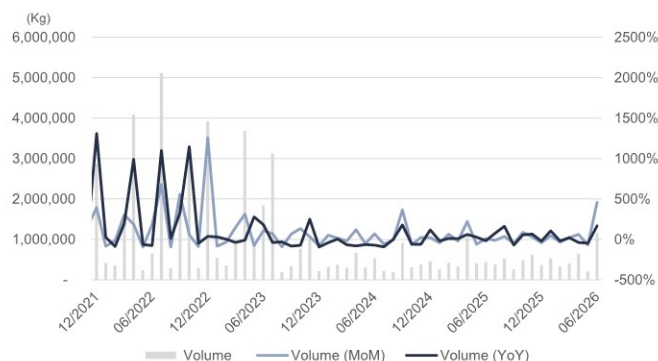
Exhibit 1: Export value for optical fiber cable (¥ mn)

Source: Ministry of Finance

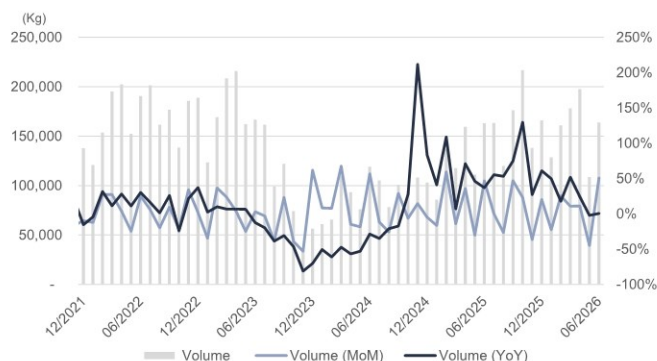
Exhibit 2: Export value for optical fiber (¥ mn)

Includes some other optical fiber cables.

Source: Ministry of Finance

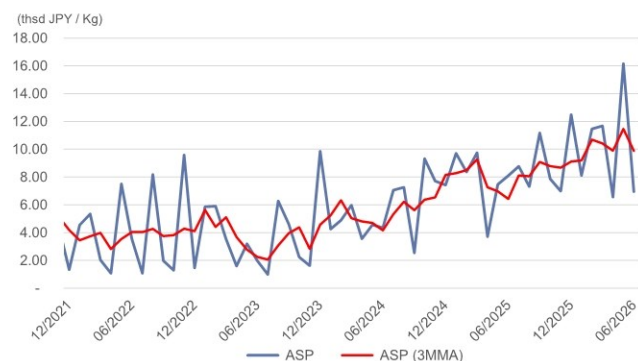
Exhibit 3: Export volume for optical fiber cable (kg)

Source: Ministry of Finance

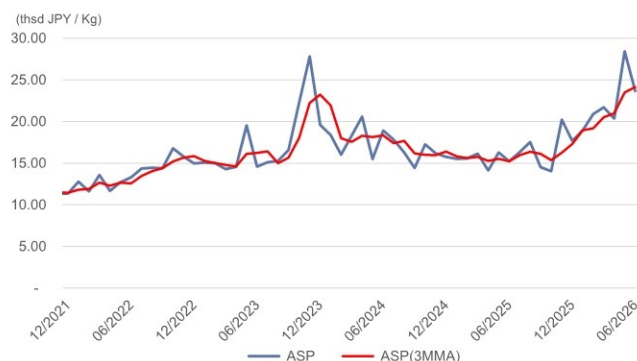
Exhibit 4: Export volume for optical fiber (kg)

Includes some other optical fiber cables.

Source: Ministry of Finance

Exhibit 5: Average export price for optical fiber cable (¥1,000/kg)

Source: Ministry of Finance

Exhibit 6: Average export price for optical fiber (¥1,000/kg)

Includes some other optical fiber cables.

Source: Ministry of Finance

Exhibit 7: Export value, volume and average export price (yoy, mom) for top 10 destinations (annual export basis)

Region	% in CY2025	Value		Volume		ASP	
		YoY	MoM	YoY	MoM	YoY	MoM
Optical Cable							
US	58%	50%	95%	-16%	66%	78%	18%
Mexico	10%	293%	1030%	243%	435%	15%	111%
China	5%	54%	-20%	102%	30%	-24%	-38%
UK	4%	-83%	247%	-69%	359%	-46%	-24%
Poland	4%	-	-	-89%	-92%	-	-
Taiwan	3%	199%	129%	311%	11%	-27%	107%
Australia	3%	687%	186%	1870%	196%	-60%	-3%
Canada	2%	195%	190%	31%	136%	125%	23%
Philippines	1%	-	937231%	-	325171%	-	188%
Vietnam	1%	415%	387%	132%	268%	122%	33%
All regions	100%	129%	140%	168%	458%	-14%	-57%
Optical Fiber							
US	54%	109%	138%	21%	117%	72%	10%
Romania	13%	-56%	-21%	-62%	-5%	16%	-16%
China	9%	4%	-39%	-51%	-50%	112%	22%
Netherlands	3%	-100%	-100%	-100%	-100%	-	-
Sweden	3%	31%	-10%	-38%	-49%	112%	77%
Turkey	3%	637%	239%	132%	214%	218%	8%
France	2%	-69%	-21%	-60%	-12%	-24%	-10%
Taiwan	2%	226%	149%	111%	116%	55%	15%
UK	1%	19%	-29%	-48%	574%	127%	-90%
UAE	1%	-	30%	-	-11%	-	46%
All regions	100%	56%	26%	0%	51%	55%	-17%

% in CY2025 is based on value for optical fiber cable and volume for optical fiber.

Source: Ministry of Finance

Exhibit 8: Export value, volume and average export price (yoy, mom) for two major European markets and the US

	% in	Value		Volume		ASP	
	CY2025	YoY	MoM	YoY	MoM	YoY	MoM
Optical Cable							
US	58%	50%	95%	-16%	66%	78%	18%
UK	4%	-83%	247%	-69%	359%	-46%	-24%
France	0%	-63%	1%	-99%	0%	6095%	1%
All regions	100%	129%	140%	168%	458%	-14%	-57%
Optical Fiber							
US	54%	109%	138%	21%	117%	72%	10%
UK	1%	19%	-29%	-48%	574%	127%	-90%
France	2%	-69%	-21%	-60%	-12%	-24%	-10%
All regions	100%	56%	26%	0%	51%	55%	-17%

% in CY2025 is based on value for optical fiber cable and volume for optical fiber.

Source: Ministry of Finance

Exhibit 9: Export value, volume and average export price by customs jurisdiction (yoy, mom)

Custom	% in CY2025	Value		Volume		ASP	
		YoY	MoM	YoY	MoM	YoY	MoM
Optical Cable							
Tokyo	37%	38%	-3%	13%	-12%	22%	10%
Yokohama	53%	226%	419%	372%	1066%	-31%	-55%
Nagoya	2%	89%	354%	-53%	234%	302%	36%
All customs	100%	129%	140%	168%	458%	-14%	-57%
Optical Fiber							
Tokyo	93%	58%	32%	2%	64%	55%	-19%
Yokohama	0%	-100%	-100%	-	0%	-	0%
Nagoya	3%	-65%	-9%	-98%	0%	1872%	-9%
All customs	100%	56%	26%	0%	51%	55%	-17%

% in CY2025 is based on value for optical fiber cable and volume for optical fiber.

Source: Ministry of Finance

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Fujikura

We are Buy rated. Our 12-month price target of ¥7,500 is based on an EV/EBITDA of 25.0X (FY3/28E; multiple based on the EV/EBITDA and EBITDA margin correlation across its domestic and global competitors). Downside risks: **Telecommunications:** A delay in benefits from hyperscaler investment, a prolonged restraint in telecom carrier investment, and competitors in ultra-high-density optical fiber cables catching up with Fujikura. **Electronics:** A greater-than-expected slowdown in the smartphone market and/or more intense competition. **Automotive products:** Automobile production volume undershooting our assumptions. **Companywide:** Forex swings.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Furukawa Electric

Our 12-month target price is ¥7,200. We apply an EV/EBITDA multiple of 25.0X (FY3/28E, based on the correlation between EV/EBITDA and EBITDA growth rate for domestic and overseas competitors). We are Buy rated. Risks: **Communications solutions:** If sales expansion of high-margin optical products for data centers does not proceed as expected and there is no improvement in profits. If the profitability of the acquired Furukawa FITELE Optical Components (FFOC) deteriorates again due to factors such as changes in competitiveness. If generative AI data center investment slows for reasons such as delays in data center construction due to supply shortages of some essential products, or if investment in generative AI data centers starts to wane as project profitability deteriorates due to price hikes for component products. **Energy infrastructure:** If demand for both high-voltage and medium/low-voltage cables slows due to factors such as a slowdown in generative AI investment. If the company decides on capex for HVDC cables but fails to secure the expected orders from customers. **Electronics & automotive systems:** If auto production volume or sales of models supplied by the company do not grow as much as expected. If fluctuations in auto production volume are larger than expected and the company is unable to absorb fixed costs through measures such as price revisions. If material prices surge more than expected and the company is unable to pass these on to customers. **Functional products:** If, in the copper foil business, sales expansion of high-function circuit foils does not proceed as planned and profitability improvement is not expected, if orders for thermal products for generative AI are not booked as sales for some reason or are delayed, or if the acquisition of new customers for semiconductor manufacturing tape does not progress as expected.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Sumitomo Electric Industries

We are Buy rated. Our 12-month target price is ¥3,400. We apply a target EV/EBITDA multiple of 13.0X (based on FY3/28E, using an SOTP approach). Key downside risks:

Automotive segment: Decline in automobile production volume; slower-than-expected pass-through of material procurement costs to selling prices. **Infocommunications segment:** Longer-than-expected inventory adjustments due to a slowdown in hyperscaler capex; catch-up by competitors in ultra-high density optical fiber cables. **Environment & energy segment:** Delays in new and replacement power infrastructure projects due to difficulties in procuring materials and securing workers; slower-than-expected earnings contributions from the Japanese government's clean energy strategy. **Industrial materials and other segments:** Slowdown in demand for cemented carbide tools, etc., due to a macroeconomic slowdown; increase in manufacturing costs for sintered parts, etc., due to rising energy prices. **Company-wide:** FX fluctuations; sustained high material prices.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Anritsu

Our 12-month target price is ¥5,300, based on a target EV/EBITDA multiple of 17X on FY3/28E (our target multiple is based on the correlation between EV/EBITDA and EBITDA margin for global competitors). We are Buy rated.

Risks: **Test and Measurement:** Demand for 5G applications has already cooled, and there is a risk that sales may not grow as expected, leading to a deterioration in profit margins. For the data center business, uncertainty due to US tariffs could lead to slower decision-making by customers, resulting in stagnating or weaker demand. Testing methods may change from 100% testing to sampling testing. **PQA:** Possible decline in domestic market share, or the failure of sales expansion to proceed as expected in regions where the company is accelerating business development, such as North America, Europe, and China. **Environmental Measurement:** The possibility that earnings in battery test equipment fail to grow as expected due to a slowdown in the BEV market. **Company-wide:** Disappointing returns from M&A and/or growth investment. An increase in the R&D expense ratio. Yen appreciation.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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Growth is based on a stock's forward-looking sales growth, EBITDA growth and EPS growth (for financial stocks, only EPS and sales growth), with a higher percentile indicating a higher growth company. **Financial Returns** is based on a stock's forward-looking ROE, ROCE and CROCI (for financial stocks, only ROE), with a higher percentile indicating a company with higher financial returns. **Multiple** is based on a stock's forward-looking P/E, P/B, price/dividend (P/D), EV/EBITDA, EV/FCF and EV/Debt Adjusted Cash Flow (DACF) (for financial stocks, only P/E, P/B and P/D), with a higher percentile indicating a stock trading at a higher multiple. The **Integrated** percentile is calculated as the average of the Growth percentile, Financial Returns percentile and (100% - Multiple percentile).

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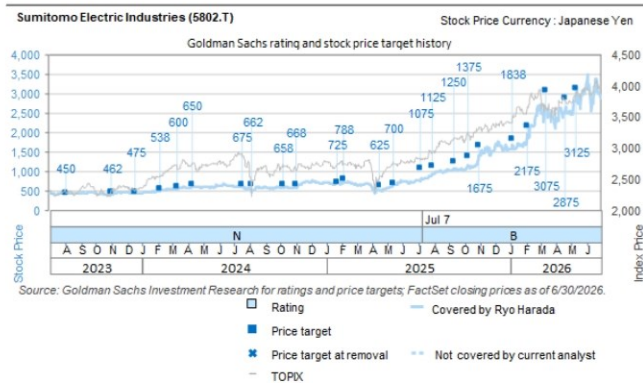
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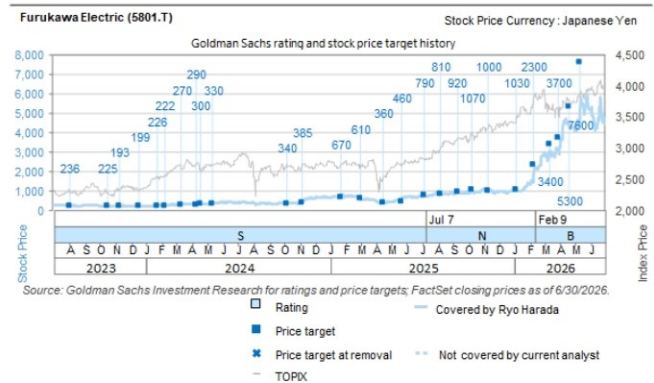
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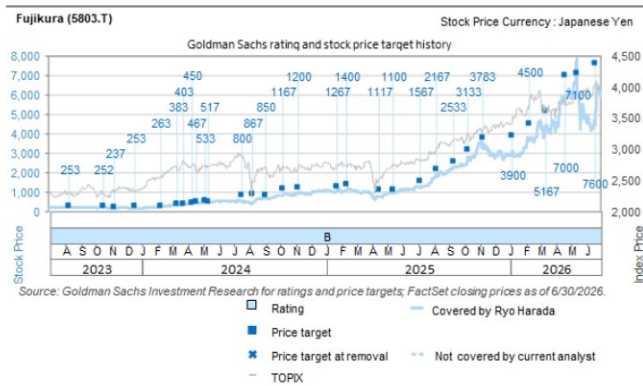
Price target and rating history chart(s)



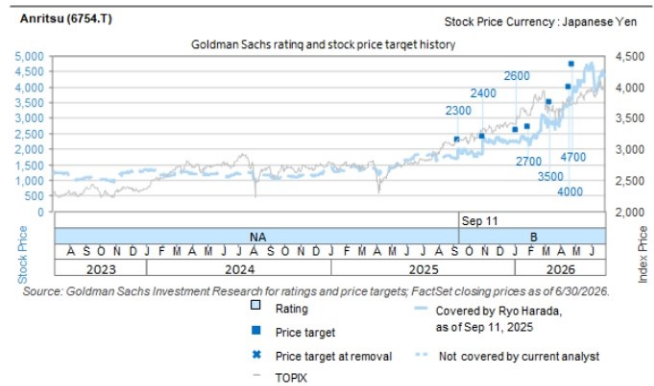
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Target price history table(s)

Sumitomo Electric Industries (5802.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
07-Jul-26	3,400	2,443
12-May-26	12,500	2,913
20-Apr-26	11,500	2,494
13-Mar-26	12,300	2,598
03-Feb-26	8,700	1,914
05-Jan-26	7,350	1,678
31-Oct-25	6,700	1,413
09-Oct-25	5,500	1,158
10-Sep-25	5,000	1,073
31-Jul-25	4,500	940
07-Jul-25	4,300	756
13-May-25	2,800	658
16-Apr-25	2,500	516
04-Feb-25	3,150	752
22-Jan-25	2,900	727
01-Nov-24	2,670	583
07-Oct-24	2,630	606
07-Aug-24	2,650	530
18-Jul-24	2,700	600

Fujikura (5803.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
07-Jul-26	7,500	5,072
18-Jun-26	7,600	4,461
14-May-26	7,100	6,355
20-Apr-26	7,000	5,529
13-Mar-26	31,000	4,420
09-Feb-26	27,000	3,659
05-Jan-26	23,400	3,074
07-Nov-25	22,700	3,403
09-Oct-25	18,800	2,798
10-Sep-25	15,200	2,272
07-Aug-25	13,000	1,918
07-Jul-25	9,400	1,235
13-May-25	6,600	957
16-Apr-25	6,700	761
10-Feb-25	8,400	1,113
22-Jan-25	7,600	1,157
07-Nov-24	7,200	968
07-Oct-24	7,000	831
02-Sep-24	5,100	736

Sumitomo Electric Industries (5802.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
09-Apr-24	2,600	602
12-Mar-24	2,400	556
05-Feb-24	2,150	501
19-Dec-23	1,900	443
02-Nov-23	1,850	404
02-Aug-23	1,800	469

Fujikura (5803.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
08-Aug-24	5,200	423
18-Jul-24	4,800	518
13-May-24	3,100	474
06-May-24	3,200	463
18-Apr-24	2,800	444
09-Apr-24	2,700	422
24-Mar-24	2,420	358
12-Mar-24	2,300	316
08-Feb-24	1,580	210
19-Dec-23	1,520	174
08-Nov-23	1,420	192
17-Oct-23	1,510	200
10-Aug-23	1,520	191

Furukawa Electric (5801.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
07-Jul-26	7,200	3,674
12-May-26	76,000	5,043
20-Apr-26	53,000	4,307
30-Mar-26	37,000	3,095
13-Mar-26	34,000	3,069
09-Feb-26	23,000	1,750
05-Jan-26	10,300	1,054
10-Nov-25	10,000	946
09-Oct-25	10,700	986
10-Sep-25	9,200	925
07-Aug-25	8,100	907
07-Jul-25	7,900	697
22-May-25	4,600	624
16-Apr-25	3,600	418
03-Mar-25	6,100	623
22-Jan-25	6,700	792
07-Nov-24	3,850	403
07-Oct-24	3,400	362
13-May-24	3,300	345
18-Apr-24	3,000	345
09-Apr-24	2,900	333
12-Mar-24	2,700	292
08-Feb-24	2,220	277
24-Jan-24	2,260	253
19-Dec-23	1,990	217
09-Nov-23	1,930	232
17-Oct-23	2,250	228
03-Aug-23	2,360	260

Anritsu (6754.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
07-Jul-26	5,300	4,056
27-Apr-26	4,700	3,755
20-Apr-26	4,000	3,466
13-Mar-26	3,500	2,891
29-Jan-26	2,700	2,369
05-Jan-26	2,600	2,288
30-Oct-25	2,400	1,887
11-Sep-25	2,300	1,745

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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